

ReportOps Reporting Escalation Policy

Synthetic knowledge source for testing multi-document RAG ingestion and retrieval. This document contains operational reporting policies that are intentionally distinct from KPI definitions and validation-rule descriptions in the primary ReportOps Reporting Handbook.

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1. Purpose and scope

This policy defines what the reporting team should do when source files arrive late, when a submitted record must be corrected, when reporting changes need documentation, or when reconciliation problems continue after an initial review. It applies to recurring monthly reporting performed with ReportOps demo data.

The policy does not define KPI formulas, validation logic, or chart-selection rules. Those topics belong to the separate ReportOps Reporting Handbook.

2. Reporting cutoff and late source files

Standard cutoff. Source files are expected by 12:00 PM local time on the second business day after the reporting period ends. A file received after that cutoff is considered late for the current reporting cycle.

When a source file is late:

- The reporting owner should record the source name, expected delivery date, actual delivery time, and reason for delay when known.
- If the late file arrives before the report is distributed, the current run should be refreshed and the new source should be included.
- If the report has already been distributed, the reporting owner should determine whether the late file changes a published number. If it does, the change must follow the correction process in Section 3.
- A late file should not be silently rolled into a later period merely to avoid reopening the current report.

Escalation trigger: two late submissions from the same source within three consecutive reporting cycles should be escalated to the reporting manager for follow-up with the source owner.

3. Correcting flagged or inaccurate records

A record should be corrected only after the reporting owner can identify the intended value from an approved source or receives confirmation from the source owner. ReportOps may flag a row for review, but the application should not autonomously overwrite source data.

For each correction, the reporting owner should:

- Preserve the original submitted value before making the change.
- Record the corrected value and the reason for the correction.
- Identify the person or approved source that confirmed the change.
- Re-run validation after the correction and confirm that no new errors were introduced.
- Recalculate affected report outputs from the corrected data rather than manually editing a displayed KPI or chart.

3.1 Corrections after report distribution

If a correction changes a value that has already been distributed, the reporting owner should assess whether the change is material to the reported result. Any material correction should be communicated with the corrected value, the previously reported value, and a brief reason for the change. The corrected report should use a new version identifier rather than replacing the prior version without notice.

4. Change documentation and version history

Every post-submission change that affects report results should create a short change record. The change record is intended to make the final output explainable without requiring someone to reconstruct the entire reporting process from memory.

A minimum change record contains:

- reporting period and source file;
- record or field changed;
- original value and corrected value;
- reason for change;
- date of change and person confirming it; and
- report version produced after the change.

Version rule: do not delete or overwrite the previously distributed reporting version when a material correction is issued. Retain enough history to show what changed between versions.

5. Repeated reconciliation failures

A reconciliation issue that remains unresolved after the first source-owner review should be tracked as an open reporting exception. The reporting owner should not repeatedly clear or suppress the same exception without documenting why the discrepancy remains acceptable.

Escalate a reconciliation problem when any of the following occurs:

- the same location or source has an unresolved reconciliation issue in two consecutive reporting cycles;
- the source owner cannot provide supporting detail for the reported components;
- a correction would require changing multiple reporting periods; or
- the discrepancy affects a number that has already been distributed to decision-makers.

5.1 Escalation sequence

Step	Action
1	Reporting owner documents the exception and requests clarification from the source owner.
2	If unresolved, the reporting manager reviews the exception and decides whether the report can proceed with disclosure.
3	If previously distributed results are affected, issue a corrected version and retain the prior version in the report history.

6. Re-running reports after changes

After a source correction or late-file update, the report should be regenerated from the updated source data. The reporting owner should re-run validation, recalculate deterministic metrics, and regenerate any affected visualizations or narrative summaries. Manually editing only the final displayed result is not an acceptable substitute for re-running the underlying workflow.

7. Policy boundaries

This document governs reporting-process timing, source-file delays, data corrections, escalation, version history, and change documentation. It does not define KPI formulas, validation-rule logic, variance thresholds, or chart-selection guidance; those subjects are maintained in the separate ReportOps Reporting Handbook.